

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Evaluate Place-Based Programmes

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C64
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Evaluate place-based programmes through theory, spatial and temporal counterfactuals, implementation, spillovers, displacement, equity, costs, uncertainty, and local context.

Why it matters

Simple before-and-after area comparisons can mistake population change or spillovers for programme impact and conceal who lost.

Illustrative application

An evaluation tests whether neighbourhood improvement reflects programme contribution, wider trends, displacement, or changes in who lives there.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.